

10 GAME CHANGERS

The future direction makeup, skincare and haircare is very quickly heading: jump on the bandwagon and get cued in
By **Shantila Lee**

BLURRED LINES

THEN

Clarins Instant Smooth Perfecting Touch

NOW

Chanel Les Beiges All-in-One Healthy Glow Fluid



1. UNBONDED

THEN: Chemical rebonding became all the rage—curly girls shrieked with joy when the dawn of new straightening technology meant they weren't doomed to the daily chore of ironing their hair.

NOW: Naturally straight locks with a bit of a bend are now *en vogue*, as opposed to fake-looking, poker-straight sticks you get from rebonding. Ergo, new haircare lines meant to tame unruly tresses into straight, unfizzy form are surging in the beauty industry, like Aveda's Naturally Straight collection (it actually progressively straightens hair over time—are you blown away?) and Kérastase's Discipline haircare range that whips wily, poufy tresses into ship shape.

2. BLURRED LINES

THEN: Women revelled in Clarins' Instant Smooth Perfecting Touch, a creamy skin saver that blurred lines and made pores shrink to almost nothingness.

NOW: The latest skin-blurring primers offer all the pore-hiding and line-concealing of the originals, and so much more: Clarins amped things up with their BB Skin Perfecting Cream packing 3D radiance pigments, and Chanel's Les Beiges Healthy Glow Fluid instantly creates a glowy, luminous haze over pores and wrinkles.

BLOWN AWAY THEN



NOW

T3 Featherweight Luxe 21 Tourmaline Hair Dryer

3. BLOWN AWAY

THEN: Emerging from an era when blow-dryers simply blew hot air at you, the rise of ionic styling tools meant less frying, more conditioning.

NOW: Newfangled tech has hit the hairstyling tool market with a bang: ceramic dryers that emit non-damaging infrared heat, the tourmaline variety with the added benefit of negative ions for a shinier, frizz-less polish, all of which pump out scorching heat at 1875 watts for faster, even drying. Brands that have come out on top are T3, Harry Josh and GHD.

4. BUH-BYE BOTOX

THEN: It was Botox or bust: the idea of an injection that could, quite literally, 'freeze' your muscles in time, facial expression bedamned, had celebs hankering for a jab or two.

NOW: A slew of new techniques for flattening wrinkles and firming saggy jowls are (some in the process of) flooding the market: stem-cell face lifts via liposuction, blood injections that use your own skin-saving proteins as wrinkle fillers, and, in a few years, Dr Fredric Brandt touts wipe-away-wrinkle hyaluronic acid gel patches that use the same stuff as Botox, only minus the pinch.

5. GEL WITH IT

THEN: Nail colour that didn't chip was the stuff of dreams until UV light-cured lacquers caused major hullabaloo and hit nail salons like wildfire..

NOW: New no-light, no-fuss nail polishes are doing away with clunky UV light lamps and tedious wrap-the-foil and wait

GEL WITH IT

THEN

UV light-powered gel manicures



NOW

Nails Inc Gel Effect Polish



forever removal methods. The upsurge of gel nail colours that last for weeks with intense, thick texture are so chic and nouveau: Nails Inc Gel Effects Polish, Sally Hansen's Miracle Gel and more vernis brands jumping into the gel game have our nails wagging.

6. TO DYE FOR

THEN: For eons, permanent hair colour required ammonia to split open the hair follicle and let the colour in. The drawback? It killed strands and had a horrible pong that made you semi-high.

NOW: Since L'Oreal launched INOA (Innovation No Ammonia), a revolutionary dye that coloured without the stink or damage, we screeched 'hallelujah!' and all pro hair colours have since been going the same way—there's Redken's Chromatics Beyond Cover, Schwarzkopf Essensity and at-home kits like Revlon Luxurious Colorsilk.

7. AIR SPRAY

THEN: Back in the 90s, airbrushed makeup was a luxury that only came along when you hired a pro makeup artist for weddings or prom.

NOW: When Dior unveiled their new Airflash spray-on foundation-in-a-tin, womankind whooped in revelation: you can take it home, saving you the drive to the makeup salon, and it goes on as light as a face mist, with a unique diffusion technology and flawlessly fuzzy, invisible coverage. More misting foundations followed suit—Sephora's Perfection Mist Airbrush Foundation is easy-peasy, and Bare Minerals' Pure Brightening Serum Foundation is mind-blowingly ultrathin. Airbrush perfection on a budget.

AIR SPRAY

THEN

Airbrush gadgets only for the pros



8. ZAP 'EM

THEN: Skin spas saw the first crop of dermatologist-wielded, stubble-zapping lasers, a permanent solution for nixing unsightly hairs sans the pain of shaving or waxing.

NOW: It's like one – zap, two – tissue off and three – you're out the door. Stores like Sephora are now swamped with DIY devices aplenty from brands like Silk'n and Tria, making attaining hairless limbs unfussy, way cheaper and less of a hassle to nail down. These gadgets pack diode-laser technology that disables the hair follicle without damaging the skin, pledging to banish all hideous hairiness within 3 months of continued use.

9. APP IT UP

THEN: When there was no internet and cell phones were the size of walkie-talkies, if you needed a beauty consultation or a try-before-you-buy thingy, you had to go find it.

NOW: It stretches from plastic surgeons using Skype for consultations, to try-it-on makeover gizmos that let you upload your photo to whack on hairstyles, colours and beyond.

Add to that a whopping load of mobile apps that do even more: Beautified schedules your facials for you, tailored shopping advice buddy MySkin and skin health trackers like Nevus.

10. LASHVATION

THEN: Rx lash serums from brands like Urban Decay were the hottest thing, creating a rush for products that boosted eyelash growth.

NOW: Having to include a separate skincare step for plumping up your lashes is SO last year's news—now, liquid liners and mascaras like Guerlain's G de Guerlain Exceptional Complete Mascara have lash care proteins and growth-stimulating ingredients built-in, jammed with hair-sprouting peptides for peppering lashes to a shiny, supple health; it's volume AND growth in a tube.

LASHVATION

THEN

Urban Decay Lush Lash System



NOW

Guerlain G de Guerlain Exceptional Complete Mascara



MORE LASHVATION: MAC's In Extreme Dimension Lash Mascara has a jumbo brush for 3D volume

